▶ UTTAR PRADESH

The New Star Pracharak (SP)



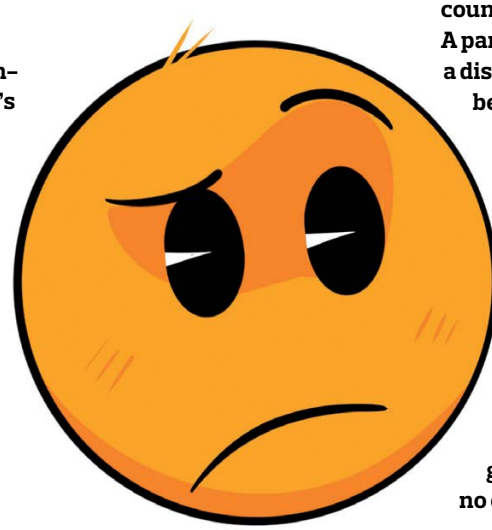
ANI

The Yadav family of the Samajwadi Party (SP) has a new star campaigner: Akhilesh's daughter **Aditi**. The 21-year-old may be pursuing a graduation in Politics & International Relations from University College London, but her real graduation—field methodology included—is happening back home in dusty Mainpuri and Kannauj, where she's learning the ropes of campaigning by pitching for mom Dimple Yadav and dad Akhilesh Yadav. Aditi is holding small meetings and nukkad sabhas in the interiors, touching on political issues, talking of how an INDIA government would empower women and create jobs. The third generation Yadav's speeches are also going viral on social media. Adoring partymen are calling it an 'internship' before her formal entry in politics, and she's apparently getting requests for putting in an appearance from other party candidates. Those close to her say she is fond of badminton and horse-riding, but politics is clearly not a mere avocation or an area of purely theoretical interest for Mulayam Singh Yadav's grand-daughter. ■

▶ ODISHA

CAPITAL OF CUTTACK, ANYONE?

Since when did districts start having capitals? A comment made by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a poll rally in Odisha's Kandhamal on May 11 has sparked this non-question, whose non-answer is the same as what you get when you multiply zero by infinity. Trying to show up the posh and westernised Odisha CM's long-alleged aloofness from his local habitat, he dared Naveen Patnaik to name all the districts of Odisha and their 'capitals' without referring to notes. It may have been an innocent form of lexical malapropism by the PM, but the internet was soon flooded with jokes, corny counter-questions and non sequiturs. A particularly telling one went thus: if a district administration were now to be run from a capital—instead of a headquarters—district magistrates may soon start wearing emperor's robes! Anyway, a day later, Naveen babu put out a response video. Speaking in his clipped Odiya, he said Modi remembers Odisha only during the polls, "which will be of no use". To recall that the two were heaping praise on each other just weeks ago, and that their parties almost got into bed with each other! Surely no one said, "What a capital idea." ■



Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**